

TITLE: Employee Leave Policy
ORGANIZATION: Northwind Analytics, Inc.
DEPARTMENT: HR
SENSITIVITY: Internal
VERSION: 3.2
EFFECTIVE_DATE: 2026-01-01

Employee Leave Policy

1. Purpose

This policy defines the types of leave available to full-time employees and the process for requesting them. It applies to all permanent employees across all office locations.

2. Types of Leave

Leave Type	Entitlement	Key Notes
Annual Leave	21 working days/year (1.75 days/month accrued)	Carries forward up to 10 days; excess lapses March 31
Sick Leave	12 days/year	Medical certificate required beyond 2 consecutive days; not carried forward
Casual Leave	6 days/year	Cannot combine with annual leave beyond 5 consecutive days without approval
Maternity Leave	26 weeks (first 2 children), 12 weeks thereafter	Per local statutory requirements
Paternity Leave	10 working days	Must be taken within 3 months of child's birth
Bereavement Leave	Up to 5 working days	For immediate family (spouse, child, parent, sibling)

3. Leave Application Process

All leave requests must be submitted through the HR portal at least 3 working days in advance, except for sick leave and emergencies. Leave requests are approved by the direct reporting manager. Leave taken without approval will be treated as unauthorized absence and may be subject to disciplinary action.

4. Unused Leave Encashment

Upon resignation or termination, employees are entitled to encashment of unused annual leave (up to the carry-forward cap of 10 days) at their last drawn basic salary rate. Sick leave and casual leave are not eligible for encashment.

5. Contact

For questions regarding this policy, contact the HR Helpdesk at hr-helpdesk@company.com or raise a ticket on the HR portal.